

Insights & Recommendations

What the scored pipeline reveals, read from the dashboard — and the concrete decision each insight drives. Six insights, four actions.

Prepared by Ndivhuwo Basis 1,116 scored SMEs · Power BI report Total funding ask R10.30bn

Scoring all 1,116 businesses produces a clear three-tier shape: a small, immediately bankable High tier, a Mid tier holding the bulk of the pipeline, and a Low tier that is a defined remediation workload rather than a write-off. Across the whole pool the businesses request **R10.30bn** of capital, average a readiness score of **54.8 / 100**, and project **26,506** new jobs.

1,116
SMES SCORED

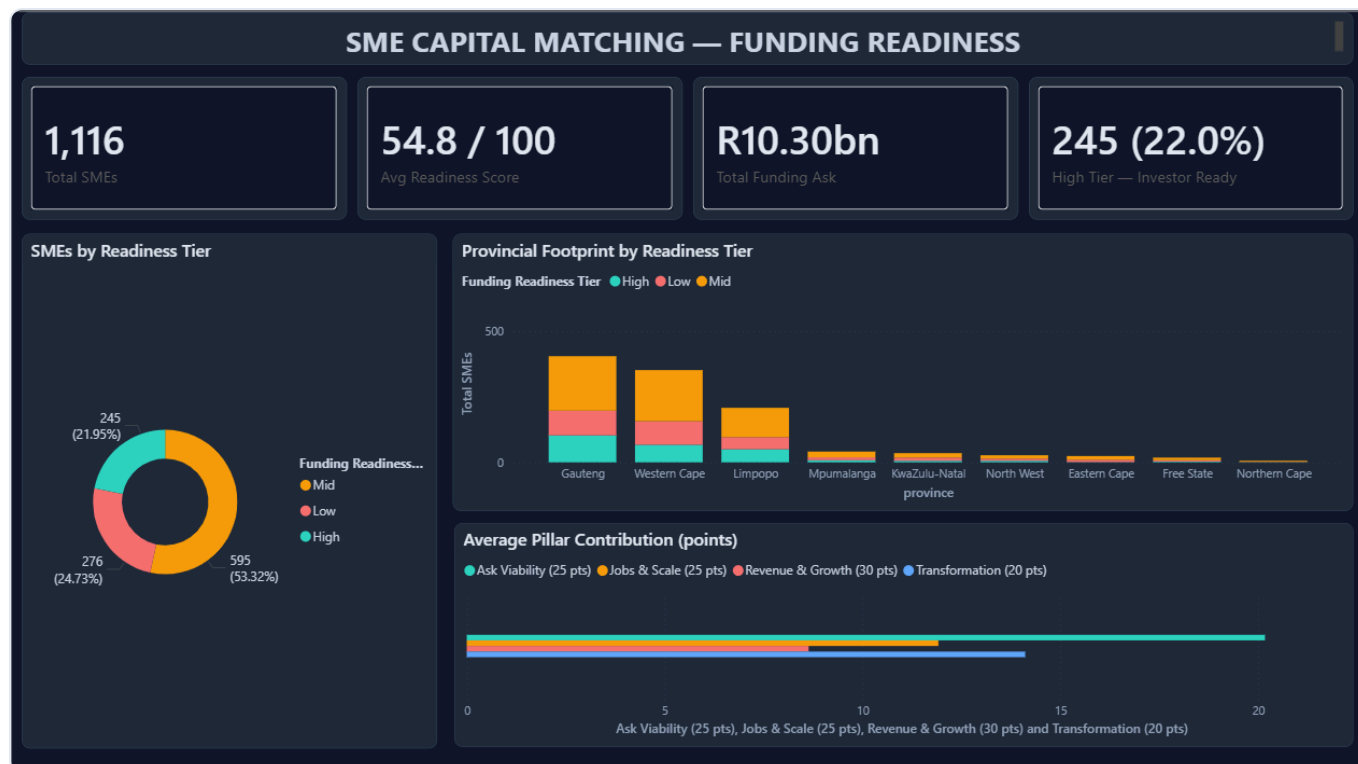
54.8
AVG READINESS / 100

R10.30bn
TOTAL FUNDING ASK

245
HIGH TIER (22.0%)

26,506
PROJECTED NEW JOBS

Tier	SMEs	Share	Total ask	Total revenue	Avg emp.	Avg new jobs	Black own.
HIGH	245	22.0%	R3.24bn	R4.05bn	23.2	47.1	95.4%
MID	595	53.3%	R2.66bn	R1.77bn	4.6	20.1	92.3%
LOW	276	24.7%	R4.40bn	R1.80bn	2.9	14.0	86.8%
Total	1,116	100%	R10.30bn	R7.62bn	—	—	91.6%



Dashboard page 1 — Funding Readiness (Executive Summary): the portfolio at a glance.

01 The insights, and the decisions they drive

1 • The High tier is the low-risk core of the pipeline

Only 22% of applicants reach the High tier, yet it is the one tier that **asks for less than it earns** — R3.24bn requested against R4.05bn of revenue. These businesses employ roughly 5,690 people, project about 11,436 new jobs, and hold the strongest transformation profile in the pool (95.4% average Black ownership).

DECISION → FUND NOW

This is an investor-ready shortlist that needs no further preparation. Package it and take it to investors immediately.

2 • The Low tier asks for the most while earning the least

Counter-intuitively, the least-ready tier carries the **largest total funding ask of all — R4.40bn** — against just R1.80bn of revenue, from the smallest businesses in the pool (2.9 employees on average). Its median request of R800K even exceeds the Mid tier's R323.5K.

DECISION → RIGHT-SIZE THE ASK

These asks are disproportionate to trading history and no funder can underwrite them as written. Recalibrating the request is the single highest-leverage intervention for the lower tiers.



Dashboard page 2 — Scoring Dashboard: High / Mid / Low investor profiles, ask-vs-revenue, jobs and B-BBEE by tier.

3 • Projected job creation is substantial and concentrated

The pool projects **26,506 new jobs** in total. The High tier alone accounts for roughly 11,436 of them — an average of 47 per business — and, because those businesses already employ at scale, it is the tier most credible to actually deliver.

DECISION → LEAD THE INVESTOR PITCH WITH JOBS

Lead with the High tier's employment and transformation impact — it is exactly the case development-finance investors are mandated to fund.

4 • Transformation credentials are strong across the entire pool

Average Black ownership is **91.6%**, and every tier scores highly on the B-BBEE pillar (15, 14 and 13 of 20 for High, Mid and Low). B-BBEE standing and inclusive ownership are precisely the criteria many investors are required to apply.

DECISION → MATCH TO MANDATE-DRIVEN FUNDERS

Surface these businesses to investors with transformation mandates, rather than leaving them undifferentiated in a pool of a thousand.

5 • The strongest businesses applied earliest

Overall application volume built through the campaign, but the High-tier businesses cluster in the **earliest submissions** — a signal that the most credible operators moved first.

DECISION → WORK THE HIGH TIER WITHOUT DELAY

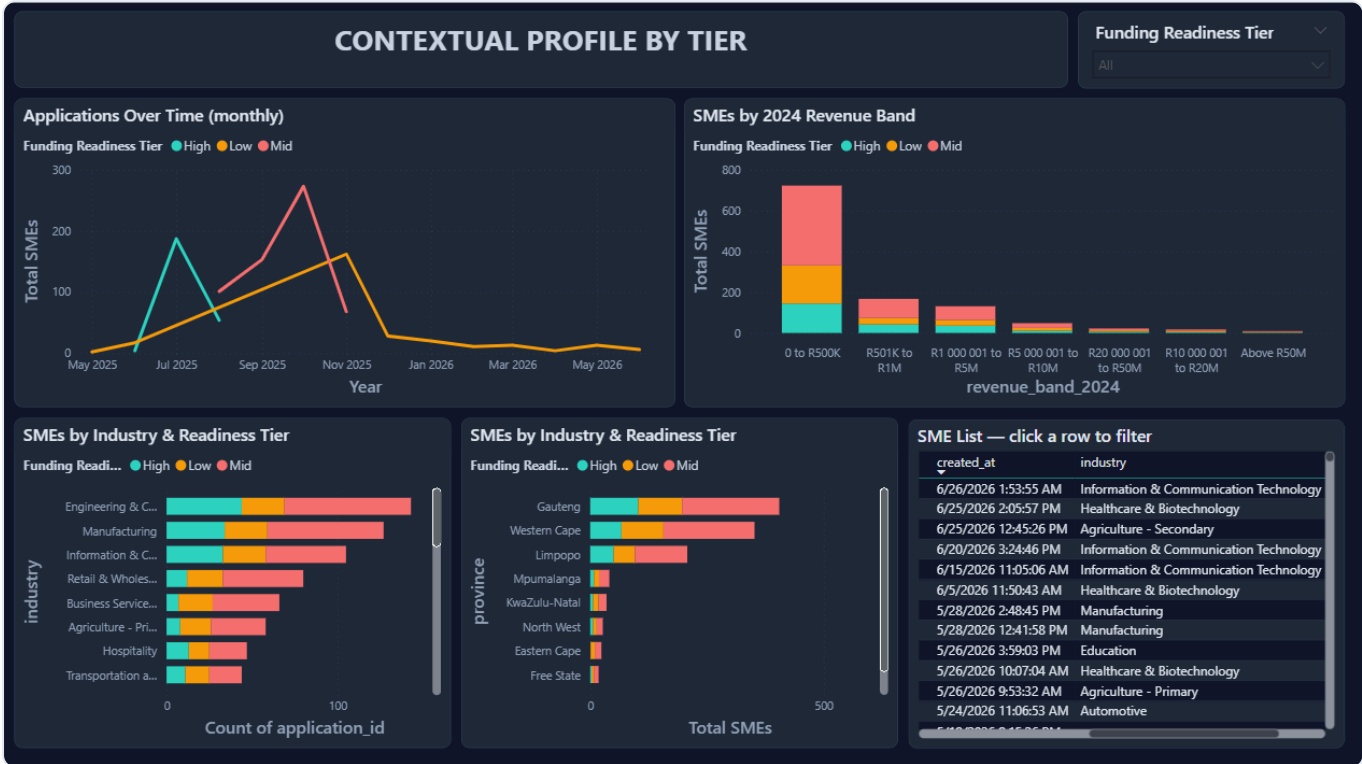
Move on the High tier now; the strongest reference stories — the ones that attract new investors — will come from there first.

6 · Applications concentrate in three provinces

Gauteng, the Western Cape and Limpopo account for the large majority of the pool, and the same three dominate the High tier.

DECISION → TARGET DEVELOPMENT EFFORT GEOGRAPHICALLY

Concentrate any in-person or targeted development work in these three provinces, where it reaches the most businesses.



Dashboard page 3 — Contextual Profile by Tier: applications over time, revenue bands, and industry / province breakdowns.

02 The actionable decisions, together

The tiers are not a ranking to be worked top to bottom; each calls for a different action, and running the three in parallel is what converts the pool into funded deals.

Action	Target	What to do, and why
FUND the High tier now	245	Investor-ready as they stand — substantive operations, meaningful headcounts, and requests smaller than revenue. Package and match to mandates by sector, province and transformation profile. This is where the fastest conversions and strongest reference stories come from.

Action	Target	What to do, and why
DEVELOP the Mid tier	595	More than half the pool and the largest source of untapped value. Genuine trading businesses whose shortcomings are specific and correctable — usually a right-sized ask or a few missing fields. Provide readiness support and re-score; this warrants the bulk of the team's development effort.
REMEDiate the Low tier over time	276	Two fixable problems: asks far out of proportion to revenue (R4.40bn against R1.80bn) and incomplete applications. Engage directly, complete the data, recalibrate the ask, then re-score — a prioritised workload for later rounds, not a write-off.
Use the pipeline as an investor-attraction asset	All	Beyond the internal priority list, the segmentation is evidence: a quantified, transformation-strong pipeline the team can put in front of prospective funders to draw new capital into the campaign.

SME Capital Funding Optimization — Insights & Recommendations

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